SESSION 10

Mid-Project Gallery Walk

Design Thinking for MBAs

Monday, February 23, 2026 | Faculty: Patrick Ray

The Arc So Far

PHASE 1
Empathy & Observation
Primary stakeholder research, observation, empathy fieldwork

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PHASE 2
Problem Definition
Systems modeling (causal loops), evidence-based problem definition

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PHASE 3 (NOW)
Pressure-Test & Communicate
Gallery walk, assumption audit, final presentations

Helpful Hint: *It doesn't look like a case study because you built it from scratch. That's harder, not easier.*

The Finish Line

TODAY (MON 2/23)

Gallery Walk

Show the evidence chain from research to concept

WEDNESDAY (2/25)

Assumption Audit + Stress Test

The class tries to break your logic

MONDAY (3/2)

Tell the Story of Your Project

9-minute team presentations + notebooks

Professional Design Critique

This is how design teams at IDEO and Google present work-in-progress. Three **Design Abilities** in play today:

Communicate Deliberately	Your station tells the story without you narrating it. The docent listens and responds, but does not present.
Build & Craft Intentionally	You chose what to include, what to leave out, and how to arrange it. Those are craft decisions about resolution.
Concrete ↔ Abstract	Show both levels. Concrete: quotes, data, causal loop. Abstract: problem definition, the "because" connecting research to concept.

Show Your Thinking

7 stations | ~4.5 minutes per station | Leave written feedback at each

At each station, look for:

1. **Problem definition** that is bounded, specific, and traceable to research
2. **Research highlights:** stakeholder quotes, observations, causal loop map
3. **Top 1-2 solution concepts** connected to specific insights

Written feedback prompts:

- **I like...** (what's working, where the logic is strong)
- **I wish...** (what you'd change or want more of)
- **I wonder...** (questions, curiosities, what-ifs)

Docents

First half (~2 min): Silence. Visitors read. Docent observes but does not speak.

Second half (~2 min): Q&A. Visitors ask questions. Docent responds, but does not present.

Halfway: Swap docents so everyone gets time in both roles.

Final round: Open visit for docents to see stations they missed.

What Did We Learn?

- **Docents:** What did visitors need you to explain that the materials didn't?
- Where was the evidence chain from research to concept clearest?
- What patterns did you notice across stations?
- Where did the logic break down, or where did a concept feel ungrounded?
- What was the most useful piece of feedback your team received?

What's Next

Reflect: What's one thing you want to change or strengthen before the final presentation?

◎ Wednesday (Session 11): **Assumption Audit + Stress Test**

Before Wednesday, identify 3-5 assumptions your concept depends on. Sort them:

Desirability	Feasibility	Viability
Do people actually want this?	*Can this actually work?*	*Should an organization invest in this?*

📝 **Find the Duct Tape:** Identify and document one workaround or improvised fix in your notebook.

See you Wednesday!